withdrawn notes swiftly. Having sufficient notes to remonetize the system was a basic precaution which should have been planned for.

If the new ₹2,000 notes had been printed in the same size as the old ₹1,000 notes, and the new ₹500 notes in the same size as the old ₹500 notes, the recalibration of 2,20,000 ATMs across the country could have been quicker. Augmenting the capacity of the 4,075 currency chests across India would have helped ensure quicker and more equitable distribution of cash across the country and faster counting of the demonetized notes as they were returned.

The fact that none of these simple and expedient measures was taken indicates that the planners of the note ban were appallingly incompetent.

As the financial and human costs of demonetization began to add up, it became painfully clear that what had been intended as a surgical strike on black money had regrettably turned out to be a carpet-bombing of the Indian people and our economy.[33]

It was a classic case of the road to hell being paved with good intentions.